MIL-C-60018A (MU)
23 MAY 1966
SUPERSEDING
MIL-C-60018 (MU)

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

# CHARGE, PROPELLING, 155MM, M119 SUPERCHARGE, LOADING, ASSEMBLING AND PACKING

## 1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers the loading, assembling and packing for one type of propelling charge designated as Charge, Propelling 155MM, M119 (XM119E4) Supercharge (charge 8) for Howitzer SP M109.

## 2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

### SPECIFICATIONS

MILITARY

MIL-A-2550 — Ammunition and Special Weapons — General Specification for.

MIL-B-45451 — Benite, Strands.
MIL-I-45607 — Inspection Equipment, Supply and Maintenance of.

### STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 — Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes (ABC-STD-105).

MIL-STD-109 — Quality Assurance Terms and Definitions.

MIL-STD-286 — Propellants: Sampling, Inspection and Testing.

MIL-STD-1168 — Lot Numbering of Ammunition.

MIL-STD-1235 — Single and Multilevel Continuous Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

### DRAWINGS

ARMY

7548187 — Packing and Marking of Metal Container for Propelling Charges.

8880530 — Container, Metal Propelling Charges: M18A1.

FSC 1320

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8882334 — Charge, Propelling 155MM: M119 Supercharge (Chg. 8) for Howitzer; SP M109.

PUBLICATIONS

ARMY

ET–8882334 — Equipment Tabulation.

(Copies of specifications, standards, drawings and publications required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

## 3. REQUIREMENTS

**3.1 Material.** Materials shall be in accordance with applicable drawings and specifications.

**3.2 Propelling charge.** The propelling charge shall comply with all requirements specified on drawing (dwg) 8882333 and 8882334, and with all requirements specified in applicable specifications.

**3.3 Moisture content of the benite strands.** The moisture content of the benite strand at the loading station, at the time of loading, shall not exceed the amount specified in Specification MIL–B–45451, when tested as specified in 4.3.1.

**3.4 Propelling charge weight.** The charge weights shall comply with the weights specified in the loading authorization within plus or minus 0.20 ounces.

**3.5 Chamber gage.** The completed propelling charge shall freely enter the prescribed chamber gage.

**3.6 Muzzle velocity.** The corrected muzzle velocity of the projectile at ambient temperature shall be not more than 691.9 meters per second nor less than 676.7 meters per second and the standard deviation of the lot shall be not greater than 3 meters per second, when tested as specified in 4.3.4.

**3.7 Workmanship.** All components shall be free of dirt, grease and other foreign material.

## 4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

**4.1 General quality assurance provisions.** Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements. Reference shall be made to Standard MIL–STD–109 in order to define the terms used herein. The provisions of Specification MIL–A–2550 shall apply.

**4.1.1** *Submission of product.* At the time the completed lot of product is submitted to the Government for acceptance the contractor shall supply the following information accompanied by a certificate which attests that the information provided is correct and applicable to the product being submitted:

(a) A statement that the lot complies with all quality assurance provisions specified within this specification.

(b) Number of units of product inspected.

(c) Results obtained, by defect code, for all inspections performed.



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(d) Drawing, specification number and date, together with an identification and date of changes.

(e) Certificates of conformance on all material purchased by the contractor when such material is controlled by Government or commercial specifications referenced in any of the contractual documents.

(f) Number of items in the lot.

(g) Date submitted.

This certificate shall be signed by a responsible agent of the certifying organization. The initial certificate submitted shall be substantiated by evidence of the agent's authority to bind his principal. Substantiation of the agent's authority will not be required with subsequent certificates unless, during the course of the contract, this authority is vested in another agent of the certifying organization.

4.1.2 *Government verification.* Using the contractor's written quality assurance procedure, this detail specification, the applicable drawings and other contractual documents as a guide, the Government inspector shall verify at unscheduled intervals all quality assurance operations performed by the contractor. Verification will be performed to the extent necessary to assure compliance with the contractual requirements. Severity of Government inspection of individual characteristics will be directly related to the seriousness of the classification assigned. In no instance will a characteristic classified "critical" be accepted solely on the basis of the contractor's records.

**4.2 Inspection provisions.**

4.2.1 *Lot formation.* A lot shall consist of cartridges produced by one manufacturer in one unchanged process, in accordance with the same drawing, same drawing revision, same specification and same specification revision. Drawing specification and process changes not affecting safety, performance or interchangeability, as determined by the Government, shall not necessitate changing the lot interfix number. The examinations and tests listed herein shall be performed on inspection lots submitted in accordance with Standard MIL–STD–105, MIL–STD–1235 or MIL–STD–414 as applicable. The criteria and procedures for the assignment of inspection lot numbers shall be in accordance with Standard MIL–STD–1168. Each lot shall contain:

(a) Propellant of one granulation from not more than one lot from one manufacturer.

(b) CBI of one lot from one manufacturer.

(c) Benite strands of one lot from one manufacturer.

(d) Potassium nitrate of one lot from one manufacturer.

(e) Wax of one lot from one manufacturer.

(f) Titanium dioxide of one lot from one manufacturer.

4.2.2 *Examination.* Inspection for critical defects shall be 100 percent. Sampling plans and procedures for major and minor defects shall be in accordance with MIL–STD–105 except that continuous sampling plans in accordance with Standard MIL–STD–1235 may be used if approved by the procuring activity. Also, at the option of the procuring activity, AQL's and sampling plans may be applied to individual characteristics listed using an AQL of 0.65 percent for each minor defect and an AQL of 0.40 percent for each major defect except when 100 percent inspection is specified.



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Equipment necessary for the performance of the inspections listed shall be in accordance with 4.2.4.

4.2.2.1 *Central igniter assembly.* (See dwg 8882336 and 8882335 covering a detail of dwg 8882334.)

| *Categories* | *Defects* | *Method of inspection* | *Code No. (see 6.2)* |
|---|---|---|---|
| Critical: | | | |
| 1. | Benite bundle missing | Visual | 01001 |
| Major: | AQL 0.65 percent | | |
| 101. | Outside diameter | Gage | 01002 |
| 102. | Total length | Gage | 01003 |
| 103. | Benite strands protruding from end of igniter tube | Visual | 01004 |
| Minor: | AQL 1.50 percent | | |
| 201. | Ties missing or improper length or improperly located | Gage | 01005 |
| 202. | Igniter tube end not returned | Visual | 01006 |
| 203. | Lacquer missing | Visual | 01007 |
| 204. | Coating missing or improper | Visual | 01008 |

4.2.2.2 *Additive insert.* (See dwg. 9216423 covering a detail of dwg 8882334.)

| *Categories* | *Defects* | *Method of inspection* | *Code No.* |
|---|---|---|---|
| Critical: | None defined. | | |
| Major: | None defined. | | |
| Minor: | AQL 1.5 percent | | |
| 201. | Weight | Scale | 02001 |
| 202. | Insert wrinkled | Visual | 02002 |
| 203. | Excessive amount of surface coating missing | Visual | 02003 |
| 204. | Evidence of poor workmanship (see 3.7) | Visual | 02004 |

4.2.2.3 *Body.* (See dwg 8882329 covering a detail of dwg 8882334.)

| *Categories* | *Defects* | *Method of inspection* | *Code No.* |
|---|---|---|---|
| Critical: | None defined. | | |
| *Major:* | *AQL 0.40 percent* | | |
| 101. | Any component missing or improperly assembled | Visual | 03001 |
| Minor: | AQL 1.5 percent | | |
| 201. | Diameter | Gage | 03002 |



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| *Categories* | *Defects* | *Method of inspection* | *Code No.* |
|---|---|---|---|
| 202. | Length, maximum (max) | Gage | 03003 |
| 203. | Evidence of poor workmanship (see 3.7) | Visual | 03004 |

4.2.2.4 *Reducer, flash.* (See dwg 9216420 covering a detail of dwg 8882334.)

| *Categories* | *Defects* | *Method of inspection* | *Code No.* |
|---|---|---|---|
| Critical: | None defined. | | |
| Major: | AQL 0.40 percent | | |
| 101. | Assembly damaged to the extent that potassium sulfate can escape | Visual | 04001 |
| 102. | Charge weight out of tolerance | Scale | 04002 |
| Minor: | AQL 2.5 percent | | |
| 201. | Any seam or opening incompletely stitched | Visual | 04003 |
| 202. | Thread broken | Visual | 04004 |
| 203. | Cloth improper | Visual | 04005 |
| 204. | Marking misleading or unidentifiable | Visual | 04006 |
| 205. | Evidence of poor workmanship (see 3.7) | Visual | 04007 |

4.2.2.5 *Charge 8 assembly.* (See dwg 8882333 covering a detail of dwg 8882334.)

| *Categories* | *Defects* | *Method of inspection* | *Code No.* |
|---|---|---|---|
| Critical: | | | |
| 1. | Base igniter assembly missing or insecure | Manual-Visual | 05001 |
| 2. | Central igniter out of position, missing or insecure | Manual-Visual | 05002 |
| Major: | AQL 0.40 percent | | |
| 101. | Assembly damaged to the extent that CBI or propellant can escape | Visual | 05003 |
| Minor: | AQL 1.5 percent | | |
| 201. | Any seam or opening incompletely stitched | Visual | 05004 |
| 202. | Thread broken | Visual | 05005 |
| 203. | Straps missing or improperly located | Visual | 05006 |

4.2.2.6 *Propelling charge.* (See dwg 8882334.)

| *Categories* | *Defects* | *Method of inspection* | *Code No.* |
|---|---|---|---|
| Critical: | None defined. | | |
| Major: | AQL 1.0 percent | | |
| 101. | Chamber gage failure (see 3.5) | Gage | 06001 |



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| *Categories* | *Defects* | *Method of inspection* | *Code No.* |
|---|---|---|---|
| 102. | Total length, max. | Gage | 06002 |
| 103. | Assembly damaged to the extent that CBI, or propellant can escape | Visual | 06003 |
| 104. | Color of cloth improper | Visual | 06004 |
| 105. | Any component missing or improperly assembled | Visual | 06005 |
| Minor: | AQL 1.5 percent | | |
| 201. | Straps loose, broken or insecurely tied | Visual | 06006 |
| 202. | Marking misleading or unidentifiable | Visual | 06007 |
| 203. | Evidence of poor workmanship (see 3.7) | Visual | 06008 |

4.2.2.7 *Container, prior to sealing.* (See dwg 8880530 and 7548187.)

| *Categories* | *Defects* | *Method of inspection* | *Code No.* |
|---|---|---|---|
| Critical: | None defined. | | |
| Major: | None defined. | | |
| Minor: | AQL 1.5 percent | | |
| 201. | Any packing component missing | Visual | 07001 |
| 202. | Cover cannot be removed by hand | Manual | 07002 |
| 203. | Charge cannot be removed by hand | Visual | 07003 |

4.2.2.8 *Container, sealed.* (Dwg 8880530 and 7548187.)

| *Categories* | *Defects* | *Method of inspection* | *Code No.* |
|---|---|---|---|
| Critical: | None defined. | | |
| Major: | None defined. | | |
| Minor: | AQL 2.5 percent | | |
| 201. | Disassembly torque, minimum (min) | Test | 08001 |
| 202. | Test plug missing or not greased | Visual | 08002 |
| 203. | Test strip missing or torn | Visual | 08003 |
| 204. | Car seal missing or incorrectly applied | Visual | 08004 |
| 205. | Marking misleading or unidentifiable | Visual | 08005 |
| 206. | Cover incompletely engaged | Manual | 08006 |

4.2.3 *Testing.*

4.2.3.1 *Moisture of benite strands (see 3.3)—major defect.* The contractor shall provide adequate controls to insure compliance with the requirements, and shall test for verification, at least one sample of benite from each eight hours production of igniter



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core assemblies. If the sample fails to comply with the applicable requirement, the eight hours production represented by the sample shall be rejected. The test shall be performed as specified in 4.3.1—code No. 09001.

4.2.3.2 *Propelling charge weight (see 3.4) and weight of CBI for base igniter loading assembly (see dwg 8882328) and benite for central igniter (see dwg 8882336) — major defect.* The charges shall be weighed and check-weighed 100 percent. The check-weighing shall be accomplished independently of the original weighing using a different balance from that used to make the original weighing and, if performed manually, shall be performed by another operator. Any charge which fails to comply with the applicable requirement shall be classed defective and removed from the lot. Equipment shall be in accordance with 4.2.4 —code Nos. base igniter loading assembly, 10001; propelling charge, 11001; benite core igniter 12001.

4.2.3.3 *Air pressure test (see dwg 7548187)—major defect.* The containers shall be checked 100 percent as specified in 4.3.2. If any container fails to meet the requirements it shall be rejected and removed from the lot—code No. 08007.

4.2.3.4. *Titanium dioxide.* (See dwg 9216423) major defect—code No. 13001.

4.2.3.4.1 *Sampling for test and treatment of results.* Three inserts shall be randomly selected from each batch and subjected to the test specified in 4.3.3. Each test shall be evaluated independently of any other test. If the three sample results from each test comply with the applicable requirements, further testing shall not be required. If either two or three of the sample results from any test(s) fail to comply with the requirement for that test, the batch shall be rejected. If only one of the sample results fails to comply with the applicable requirement, that result which fails to comply shall be tested for possible classification as an "extreme observation" (see 6.4), as follows:

(a) If the result failing to comply with the requirement is the highest value observed, the following test shall be made:

$$\text{If } \frac{H-M}{H-L} = 0.941\text{—the highest value shall be considered an "extreme observation"}$$

(b) If the result failing to comply with the requirement is the lowest value, the following test shall be made:

$$\text{If } \frac{M-L}{H-L} = 0.941\text{—the lowest value shall be considered an "extreme observation"}$$

Where:

H = highest value.

M = middle value.

L = lowest value.

4.2.3.4.1.1 *"Extreme observation" (see 6.4).* If classified by the above criteria as an "extreme observation," the three sample results shall not be evaluated, and three additional samples shall be selected and subjected to the particuar test(s) produc-



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ing the extreme observation(s). If in these additional samples, one or more result fails to comply with the requirement, the batch shall be rejected.

4.2.3.4.1.2 *Not an "extreme observation."* If the suspected result is not classified as an "extreme observation," an additional six samples per batch shall be selected and subjected to the particular tests) which one sample previously failed. If the results of all six samples comply with the requirement(s), no further testing shall be required. If one sample fails this retest, the batch shall be rejected.

4.2.3.5 *Muzzle velocity (see 3.6.1)—major defect.* Seven propellant charges shall be randomly selected from each lot for this test. If the sample fails to comply with velocity or if the standard deviation of the sample multiplied by the factor 0.69 exceeds the applicable lot requirement, the lot shall be rejected, when tested as specified in 4.3.4.

4.2.4 *Inspection equipment.* Equipment tabulation number ET–8882334 identifies the inspection equipment required to perform the examinations and tests prescribed in this section. The contractor shall design inspection equipment in accordance with the instructions in paragraph 6.3.

4.2.4.1 *Government rights to documentation.* Inspection equipment drawings and lists provided and revised in accordance with the requirements of the ET may be used by DOD activities for design, procurement, manufacture, testing, evaluation, production and receiving inspection, overhaul, shipping, storage, identification of stock, ordering and storage of replacement parts, inspection of items at overhaul, general maintenance of equipment, construction, survey, and whenever inspection equipment drawings are needed.

4.2.4.2 *Supply and Maintenance.* Supply and maintenance of the equipment listed in the ET shall be in accordance with specification MIL–I–45607.

4.2.4.3 *Government use of contractor's inspection and test equipment.* The contractor shall make available to the Government all inspection and test equipment necessary for determining conformance with contract requirements. Personnel for operating the equipment, and verification of its accuracy, shall be supplied by the contractor for the performance of examination or test by the Government.

**4.3 Test methods and procedures.**

4.3.1 *Moisture of benite strands.* The moisture content of the benite strands shall be determined in accordance with MIL–STD–286, method 102.1.

4.3.2 *Air pressure test for container.* The container shall be subjected to an internal pressure of 3 pounds per square inch using test equipment in accordance with 4.2.4. A pressure drop equivalent to 3 inches of water in 15 seconds shall be cause for rejection.

4.3.3 *Titanium dioxide.* An accurately weighed specimen of approximately 1 gram of the additive shall be removed from the cloth and transferred to a tarred crucible. The crucible and contents shall be ignited with a Bunsen-Burner until the flame is no longer visible. The crucible shall be transferred to a muffle furnace maintained at 700 plus or minus 5 degrees Centigrade and heated until all organic matter has burned off. The sample shall be cooled in a desiccator, then weighed. The gain in weight of the tared crucible shall be considered to be titanium dioxide.

4.3.4 *Muzzle velocity.* The propelling charges shall be assembed with inert loaded projectile and dummy fuzes at ambient temperature and fired for muzzle velocity.



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## 5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

**5.1 Packing.**

5.1.1. *Level A.* The propelling charges shall be packed in a container complying with dwg 8880530. Containers shall be closed, sealed, tested and marked in accordance with the requirements of dwg 7548187.

## 6. NOTES

**6.1 Ordering data.** Procurement documents shall specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.

(b) Data cards. Data cards shall be prepared for each lot in accordance with the information specified in Standard MIL–STD–1167.

**6.2 Inspection code numbers.** The five digit code numbers assigned to the inspections herein are to facilitate future data collection and analysis by the Government.

**6.3 Inspection equipment.** The contractor shall design inspection equipment as required by the referenced inspection Equipment Lists (EL) in accordance with the instructions of paragraph 6.3.1 through 6.3.7.

6.3.1 *Inspection equipment lists.* Inspection equipment lists indicate the availability of inspection equipment designs by showing in the "number" column of the list of inspection equipment (SMUPA Form 1010) the numbers of drawings of existing equipment designs or codes as indicated in paragraph 6.3.2. Design action required of the contractor with respect to the different types of drawings that may be listed is described in paragraphs 6.3.3 and 6.3.4. Action required by the contractor with respect to commercial inspection equipment is described in 6.3.5. The contractor will be required to prepare detailed drawings in accordance with 6.3.6 for all the equipment coded as "Contractor Design" in the number column. These contractor designs must be approved by the Government prior to fabrication or procuring of the equipment. Designs shall be submitted for approval as specified in 6.3.7.

6.3.2 *Inspection equipment list codes.* The inspection equipment as defined in 6.3.3, 6.3.4, 6.3.5 and 6.3.6 will be designated in the EL by the following codes:

CDAF — Contractor's design responsibility on Army format in accordance with MIL–D–45608.

CDCF — Contractor's design responsibility on contractor format.

AD — Army design.

ADMU — Army design, mandatory for use.

CE — Commercial equipment.

SCD — Specification control drawing.

6.3.3 *Army designs.* Army designs are reflected on detailed drawings which completely depict all the information necessary for the fabrication of the item of inspection equipment. The contractor need provide no design when an Army design is listed for an item of inspection equipment. Army designs fall into two basic classifications, mandatory and nonmandatory. When an inspection equipment list references mandatory Army designs, the contractor shall comply with, and use these designs accordingly. The contractor may, however, in connection with nonmandatory designs and with the approval of the Government, design alternate inspection equipment or use



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comparable commercial equipment to facilitate his operations. Such contractor prepared designs (see 6.3.6) or commercial equipment selections (see 6.3.5) must be approved by the Government prior to fabrication or procuring of the equipment. Designs shall be submitted for approval as specified in 6.3.7.

6.3.4 *Specification control drawing.* Specification control drawings depict the minimum equipment requirements in outline, descriptive, diagrammatic or pictorial form only and specify the required performance or other characteristics. Contractors must prepare detailed drawings (see 6.3.6) of their designs in support of specification control drawings. These contractor prepared designs must be approved by the Government prior to the fabrication or procuring of the equipment. Commercial equipment meeting the requirements of specification control drawings must be described in sufficient detail to permit identification and evaluation by the Government (see 6.3.5). Designs shall be submitted for approval as specified in 6.3.7.

6.3.5 *Commercial equipment.* Commercial equipment is inspection equipment that has universal application for a specific function. It is comprised of items commonly used by industry and Government. Contractors normally are not required to furnish drawings of commercial inspection equipment, but a list of such equipment must be approved by the Government. When commercial inspection equipment requires the use of special fixturing, the design of this fixturing shall be considered as part of the total design, and 6.3.6 shall apply. In the latter case, only those portions of the commercial equipment need be detailed in the designs as are necessary to completely fabricate, calibrate, and operate the total item of inspection equipment. Lists and fixturing designs shall be submitted for approval as specified in 6.3.7.

6.3.6 *Contractor designs.* Contractor designs are designs of inspection equipment for which the Government has assigned design responsibility to the contractor. Contractor designs shall be supported by detailed drawings which depict all information necessary to completely fabricate, calibrate and operate an item of inspection equipment. This requires that the necessary views, dimensions, materials, finish, notes, operating and calibration instructions be properly depicted in accordance with approved practices to the extent that further calculation or clarification will not be required. Contractor designs identified as CDCF may be developed on the format the contractor normally employs in his equipment design procedure provided such format reflects the detail and information specified above. Contractor designs identified as CDAF shall comply with the format and requirements of MIL–D–45608, and in addition, contain the detail and information specified above. Final approved contractor designs identified as CDAF shall be suitable for microfilming. They must be nonreproducible diazo or electrostatic prints of top quality, full size, with black lines on white background, and shall provide a legible print produced via the 35-mm microfilm process. Contractors shall submit one copy of the final design as a rolled set or flat set. Designs shall be submitted for approval as specified in 6.3.7.

6.3.7 *Submission of contractor designs.* Unless otherwise specified on the EL, all designs of equipment for inspection of defects classified as critical and major shall be submitted for approval to the Commanding Officer, Picatinny Arsenal, ATTN: SMUPA–ND. All other designs of inspection equipment shall be approved by the inspection element of the agency administering the contract; submission shall be as directed by the Contracting Officer. Partial submission of inspection equipment designs is permissible and encouraged. However, the Arsenal completion date for design re-



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view will be based on the date of the final submission of designs. Picatinny Arsenal design review will be accomplished normally within one month after receipt.

6.4 "Extreme observation" is defined as an observation that is too far removed from the other observations to warrant the assumption that it is from the same population as the other observations; the probability of such an assumption is less than 5 percent.

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**Project No. 1320–A106**



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# SPECIFICATION ANALYSIS SHEET

*Form Approved*
Budget Bureau No. 119-R004

INSTRUCTIONS

This sheet is to be filled out by personnel either Government or contractor, involved in the use of the specification in procurement of products for ultimate use by the Department of Defense. This sheet is provided for obtaining information on the use of this specification which will insure that suitable products can be procured with a minimum amount of delay and at the least cost. Comments and the return of this form will be appreciated. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity.

SPECIFICATION

| ORGANIZATION | CITY AND STATE |
|---|---|
| | |

| CONTRACT NO. | QUANTITY OF ITEMS PROCURED | DOLLAR AMOUNT |
|---|---|---|
| | | $ |

MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A

☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE SPECIFICATION CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY SPECIFICATION REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE SPECIFICATION RESTRICTIVE?

☐ YES ☐ NO IF "YES", IN WHAT WAY?

4. REMARKS *(Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this specification. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity)*

| SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and activity)* | DATE |
|---|---|
| | |

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PICATINNY ARSENAL
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